

he would have to better understand how the eye received light and formed images.

Eventually, Leonardo won the support of an important patron, Lorenzo de Medici. Lorenzo was now the leader of the ruling Medici family, although he was less interested in business dealings than his grandfather Cosimo had been. He was, however, dedicated to using his family's influence and money to encourage a flourishing culture for artists in Florence.



Lorenzo de Medici

In 1481, Leonardo received an important commission.

It came from the monks in a local monastery, and its subject was a scene from the New Testament of the Bible. The title of the painting, which measured 8 ft by 8 ft (2.5 m by 2.5 m), was the *Adoration*

*of the Magi*. The painting captured the moment when the Three Kings, or Magi, who had come from far away bearing gifts, first saw the baby Jesus.